

Working with ls command: listing the contents of a directory

To list the contents of any directory, ls command is used. To see the contents of the current working directory one just has to type the ls in the command prompt:

- `[me@linuxbox ~]$ ls`
- Desktop Documents Music Pictures Public Templates Videos

If you have any specific directory in mind that you want to know the content of, just mention the same after ls.

- `me@linuxbox ~]$ ls /usr`
- bin games kerberos libexec/sbin/src
- etc include lib local share tmp

you can even mention multiple directories:

- `[me@linuxbox ~]$ ls ~ /usr`
- /home/me:
- Desktop Documents Music Pictures Public Templates Videos
- /usr:
- bin games kerberos libexec/sbin/src etc include lib local share tmp

Changing the current working directory

To change the current working directory, the cd command is used. To do this, cd followed by a well-defined pathname is used leading up to the desired directory of users. If you are wondering what a pathname is, it is the route of branches taken in a tree system to reach the desired branch of the tree.

Pathnames in Linux can be defined in either of the two ways: Absolute Pathnames or Relative Pathnames.

• Absolute pathnames

An absolute pathname as the name suggests is a path that is traced from the root directory to the desired working directory until it is reached. Take the example of the bin directory; for example, you have to reach the bin directory of your system; the following commands will be followed in that case:

- `[me@linuxbox ~]$ cd /usr/bin`
- `[me@linuxbox bin]$ pwd`
- /usr/bin
- `[me@linuxbox bin]$ ls`

You can see, to reach the bin directory, the full path length has been traced. This is called using absolute pathnames.

• Relative pathnames

The primary difference between an absolute pathname and relative pathname is that while an absolute pathname starts from the root directory and finds